FarmTrace — Customer Personas & ICP

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Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Who is FarmTrace built for?

FarmTrace's ideal customer is a small-scale farmer in South India (specifically Karnataka) who grows 1–5 acres of vegetables or fruits, has a basic Android smartphone, and sells produce through local mandis or aggregators. They practice good farming methods — often organic or natural — but are unable to prove this to buyers and therefore receive lower prices than their quality deserves.

ICP Attribute	Description
Geography	Karnataka, India (pilot: Kolar, Tumkur, Chikkaballapur districts)
Farm size	1–5 acres (marginal to small farmer)
Crops	Tomato, chilli, beans, leafy vegetables, mango
Farming method	Organic, natural, or reduced-chemical farming
Digital literacy	Basic smartphone user — WhatsApp, calls, YouTube
Annual income	₹1–3 lakhs from farming
Selling channel	Local mandi, aggregators, occasionally direct buyers
Problem intensity	High — regularly loses 15–30% of potential income to trust gap

Persona 1 — The Farmer

Ravi Kumar — Small-Scale Vegetable Farmer, Kolar

Profile

Age: 38
Education: 10th std
Farm: 3 acres, tomato + chilli
Phone: Android, uses WhatsApp
Sells: Local mandi + 1 aggregator
Income: ~₹1.8 lakh/year

Pain Points

- Buyers don't believe his tomatoes are pesticide-free
- Gets ₹8/kg when the same quality sells for ₹14/kg in organic shops
- Has no way to prove harvest date — buyers assume produce is old
- Tried making a WhatsApp group but buyers still didn't trust

What FarmTrace gives them: Proof of organic farming • Higher price from direct buyers • Simple QR to generate — 2 minutes on phone

"I grow the best tomatoes in Kolar. But nobody believes me. I just want someone to see the truth."

Persona 2 — The Buyer

Priya Menon — Procurement Manager, Organic Grocery Chain, Bengaluru

Profile

Age: 31
Education: MBA
Company: Mid-size organic store chain
Buys: 500+ kg vegetables weekly
Challenge: Verify organic claims
Location: Bengaluru, Karnataka

Pain Points

- Cannot verify farmers' organic claims — no documentation
- Has been cheated before with 'fake organic' produce
- Spends 2+ hours per week on supplier verification calls
- Rejects 20–30% of produce batches due to lack of traceability

What FarmTrace gives them: Instant QR scan to verify origin and method • Reduces verification time from 2 hours to 5 minutes • Builds long-term trusted supplier network

"If I could scan a QR code and know this came from an organic farm in Kolar, I'd pay 20% more without hesitation."

Persona 3 — The Aggregator

Profile

Age: 45
Business: Collects from 30+ farmers
Delivers to: Bengaluru wholesale market
Volume: 3–5 tonnes per week
Challenge: Disputes about quality
Phone: Android, Google Maps user

Pain Points

- Blamed for quality loss that happens before he collects
- Buyers refuse batches citing 'unknown origin' even when quality is good
- No way to document his handling and cold storage properly
- Loses business to competitors who have certificates

What FarmTrace gives them: Can add handling events to farmer QR batches • Creates accountability trail for his leg of the journey • Reduces buyer disputes by showing documented handling

Summary — Customer Journey Map

Stage	Farmer (Ravi)	Buyer (Priya)
Awareness	Hears about FarmTrace from agricultural officer or WhatsApp group	Sees QR code on a vegetable batch at the mandi
Interest	Watches demo video; realizes he can prove organic farming	Scans QR; sees full farm history — impressed
Trial	Registers first batch in < 2 minutes; gets QR	Verifies 3 batches; all correct — builds confidence
Adoption	Registers every batch; shares QR with buyers	Starts preferring FarmTrace-tagged suppliers
Loyalty	Teaches other farmers in his village to use it	Pays premium price for verified FarmTrace produce